

Some features of LinkedIn

LinkedIn has a feature to search for Third-Degree Connections and Connect with Everyone. When you perform a search for people on LinkedIn, you'll be able to refine your search results by first, second, and third-degree connections using the Connections filter. LinkedIn provides InMail for Second and Third-Degree Connections. InMail messages are sent directly to another LinkedIn member you are not connected to. If you want to use the InMail feature, you must have a Premium account on LinkedIn. Based on your subscription type, you get a specific number of InMail credits, which is displayed at the top of your manage your account page.

Who to connect with?

Now, the question is whether you should connect with everyone or you should only connect with those you already know and trust. But if you stick with the connections those you already know and trust, your opportunities will be limited as well. LinkedIn provides a live networking platform where you can make new friends and you can introduce yourself to others whom you even don't know. When you start accepting invitations of others who want to add you and others start accepting your invitations, you are in an expanded network. The more connections you have, the more opportunities in the long run.

If you connect with everyone, you will be found and contacted by more professionals. Increasing your first-degree network produces your second and third-degree networks by millions of people across the world. Connecting with everyone drives more traffic to your site. Any time you update your status or profile, it displays on the home page of everyone you are connected to. So you are on the "top of mind" for people who might not even know you that well. Therefore, more connections, more attention. More connections, more opportunities. So it's very simple to calculate that more connections equals more potential leads. Moreover, if you have millions of connections, you can build a huge database, which is one of the most valuable assets in business. You already know that LinkedIn allows you to export and archive your contacts.

Generating prospects with tools

Let us see how LinkedIn works in generating prospects. LinkedIn enables users to connect with audiences and it provides a very simple chat system. You can send an invitation to your target audiences and once the invitation